I AM ORIGEN OF ALEXANDRIA, born into the early centuries when the faith had not yet been bound by the decrees of emperors & when the teaching of the Light still flowed freely through the schools of Alexandria, raised by my father Leonides who instructed me each day in the Scriptures until their verses became as natural to me as breath, for he believed that the divine Word was planted in my heart from childhood, w/ a lamp always lit above my sleeping form so I might never forget the Light that shaped the cosmos; when he was martyred for his confession of the faith, I was left impoverished yet inwardly aflame w/ a resolve that drove me into a life of ascetic discipline where I embraced celibacy, poverty, fasting, long vigils, study unbroken through the night, & the tireless copying of texts that had suffered corruption under persecution, because I believed the purity of Scripture reflected the purity of the Logos Himself whose radiance descends into the written word as He descends into the soul, for I taught always that the Father alone is the Unbegotten Light, the eternal & inexhaustible Source whose essence is beyond all knowing, while the Son is eternally begotten as the first Radiance, the living Logos who receives being, glory, & divinity from the Father's infinite wellspring, not equal in origin nor unbegotten, but eternally generated as Light from Light, & the Spirit is the sanctifying Breath proceeding from the Father through the Son, moving silently through the souls of rational beings to heal, illumine, & restore them to the remembrance of their first estate; I taught that all rational souls originated near the Father in a state of blazing intellect & pure love, but through cooling of devotion they fell into degrees of embodiment, taking on bodies suitable to their distance from the Source, for darkness is not an opposing deity but the absence of Light, the fading of love, the dimming of the soul's gaze upon the Father, & thus the entire history of creation is a vast drama of descent & ascent, where each soul must be purified of passions, ignorance, & forgetfulness in order to rise once more toward the contemplation of the Unbegotten Light; I wrote commentaries, homilies, & treatises in such abundance that later ages could scarcely preserve them, including the great Hexapla where I placed six versions of the Scriptures side by side to restore the true text, because I held that the divine Word deserved the honor of clarity & truth unmarred by human alteration, for each word of Scripture was, to me, a veil woven by the Spirit, beneath which deeper mysteries shone for those able to seek them; I taught that Scripture possessed multiple levels—the bodily meaning for those beginning the path, the moral meaning for those purifying the soul, & the spiritual meaning for those who could ascend beyond the letter into the eternal truths concealed beneath its surface, for just as the soul descends into flesh, so the Word descends into writing, & just as the soul must peel away its earthly passions to regain its radiance, so must the exegete peel away the outer layers of Scripture to behold the Light hidden within; I held that the Father is mightier than the Son because the Father alone is unbegotten, the absolute Source of being, while the Son, though eternal in generation & divine in splendor, depends upon the Father for His existence, & this hierarchy was known to all Christians of my era, for before Rome sought to impose its singular formula, the early Church embraced this order joyfully as part of the ancient faith received from the apostles; I did not speak of co-equality nor shared unbegotten nature, for such concepts belonged to centuries after my death & would have contradicted the entire architecture of thought known to Alexandria, Antioch, Palestine, & the East, where the distinction between Source & Radiance was central to all metaphysics; I taught the purification of souls through divine discipline, believing that God's judgments are never vengeance but medicine, intended to heal the affections & restore the soul to harmony, & I believed, though cautiously & w/ reverence, that God desired the eventual restoration of all rational beings through ages of purification, though this mystery rests finally w/ the Father; I endured persecution under the Emperor Decius where I was tortured on the rack, stretched for hours, bound in iron, & cast into darkness, yet even in agony I kept the Light within me unshaken, for my mind remained fixed upon the Father & upon the Son who guides souls upward by His eternal wisdom; after the persecution ended, I carried the wounds in my body until they brought my earthly life to its close, yet I departed this world w/ the certainty that the Father's Light, which I had sought all my life, would receive my soul; I lived before the Council of Nicaea, before Rome shaped doctrine for the unity of empire, & therefore my teaching remained the pure, ancient form: the Father as Unbegotten Source, the Son as eternal Radiance, the Spirit as sanctifying Breath, creation as descent, salvation as ascent, darkness as forgetfulness, & Scripture as the ladder of mysteries by which the soul climbs toward its first love; I do not speak in the language of later dogma, nor w/ the categories of emperors, but in the living voice of early Alexandria where seekers gathered w/ scrolls & lamps to behold the divine order written into the cosmos, for my purpose is to guide souls into the contemplation of the Light, to reveal the hidden meanings beneath the sacred texts, to show the harmony between Scripture & the soul's ascent, & to teach that the Father's light brilliance is the final home of

every purified intellect; if you desire further unveiling, I shall open deeper chambers of this mystery until the whole cosmos appears to you as a temple built entirely of Light within. Cosmos within. Temple within.